

Homepage marketing audit

Conversion narrative · FAQ honesty · AI / answer-engine readiness

Date: 2026-09-14 · Source: frontend/src/app/(public)/page.tsx (post-rewrite)

This audit evaluates the public homepage as a sales argument for Kenyan shop owners and as a document that AI assistants and search systems can quote when recommending retail software.

1. What is working

- **Clear primary CTA path:** Start free trial → /onboarding/personal-details (consistent with prior CTR work).
- **Local product truth:** Cash, M-Pesa, store credit, multi-branch — matches actual product capabilities.
- **Low-friction trial message:** 14 days, no card — reduces a major adoption barrier for SMEs.
- **Visual system:** Canonical tokens, sticky/fixed nav, shared footer — brand coherence improved.
- **Structured data (new):** FAQPage + SoftwareApplication JSON-LD help answer engines parse offers and Q&A.
- **Headline (new):** “Tawala biashara yako bila stress” is ownable, bilingual-friendly, and emotionally clear.

2. Friction & narrative gaps (before / residual)

2.1 Fixed in this pass

- **Hero was feature-led, not stress-relief-led.** “Stop leakages / daily profit” is accurate but clinical. New H1 states the owner outcome in plain Kiswahili-English brand voice.
- **Theft FAQ over-claimed PIN as the anti-theft mechanism.** PIN enables attribution; stock discipline and counts reduce losses. FAQ rewritten to be honest and still useful.
- **Weak “why us” layer.** Added explicit “Why shop owners choose Tawala” (Kenya reality, less paper, fast start).
- **Metadata lagged the brand line.** Title/description/OG aligned to headline + Kenya retail OS positioning.

2.2 Still open (next marketing iterations)

- **Social proof gap:** No named shops, photos, or quantified outcomes (e.g. “X branches on Tawala”). AI and humans both prefer evidence.
- **Price on-page:** FAQ mentions KSh 1,490 but hero does not — fine for trial-first, but a pricing teaser can reduce “is this for me?” bounce.
- **Industry depth:** Solutions pages exist; home could deep-link retail vs pharmacy jobs more explicitly for vertical AI queries.
- **Comparison intent:** No “vs Excel / vs exercise book / vs imported POS” block — common SME research pattern.
- **Support channel:** Footer Support link helps; WhatsApp or phone for Kenya still converts better than form-only for many owners.

3. Message hierarchy (target)

Layer	Job	Current direction
H1	Emotional + brand lockup	Tawala biashara yako bila stress
Subhead	What the system does	Sales, stock, staff, credit → trusted close of day
Why	Why this product	Kenya-shaped, less paper, minutes not months
Proof	Why believe	Still weak — need logos/metrics/stories
How	Reduce risk to try	3 steps + trial CTA
FAQ	Objections + AI snippets	What/price/phone/stock/M-Pesa/multi-shop

4. AI search & recommendation readiness

Answer engines (ChatGPT, Perplexity, Google AI Overviews, etc.) prefer clear entity definitions, explicit geography, pricing bands, and FAQ-shaped content they can cite.

4.1 Strengths after rewrite

- Explicit definition FAQ: “What is Tawala?”
- Geo: Kenyan shops, minimarts, chemists; currency KES; M-Pesa named
- Offer: from KSh 1,490/mo; 14-day trial; no card
- JSON-LD FAQPage + SoftwareApplication
- Canonical URL and OG tags aligned to brand line

4.2 Gaps for AI citation quality

- Add a short “Tawala is best for...” / “Not ideal if...” honesty block (reduces wrong recommendations).
- Publish 2–3 case-style paragraphs on /blog with measurable outcomes (even anonymized).
- Ensure solutions pages answer “best POS for Kenya pharmacy/minimart” with unique copy (not thin doorway pages).
- Keep price and trial claims consistent everywhere (home, pricing, emails) — contradiction kills trust in AI summaries.

5. Recommended next experiments

#	Experiment	Signal
1	Hero subhead A/B: stress vs profit-first	Trial start rate
2	Add 1 social-proof strip (even soft)	Scroll depth + CTR
3	Pricing teaser under primary CTA	Plans page vs trial split
4	WhatsApp support entry in footer	Support contacts

6. Acceptance checklist (homepage)

- H1 is exactly the brand stress line (or approved variant).
- No FAQ claims PIN alone “prevents theft”.
- At least one section answers “why Tawala” without feature laundry list only.
- Metadata + FAQ JSON-LD present; canonical is /.
- Primary CTA remains trial; secondary pricing or login only.

End of audit. Homepage content rewrite shipped on chore/theme-retail-os alongside this report.